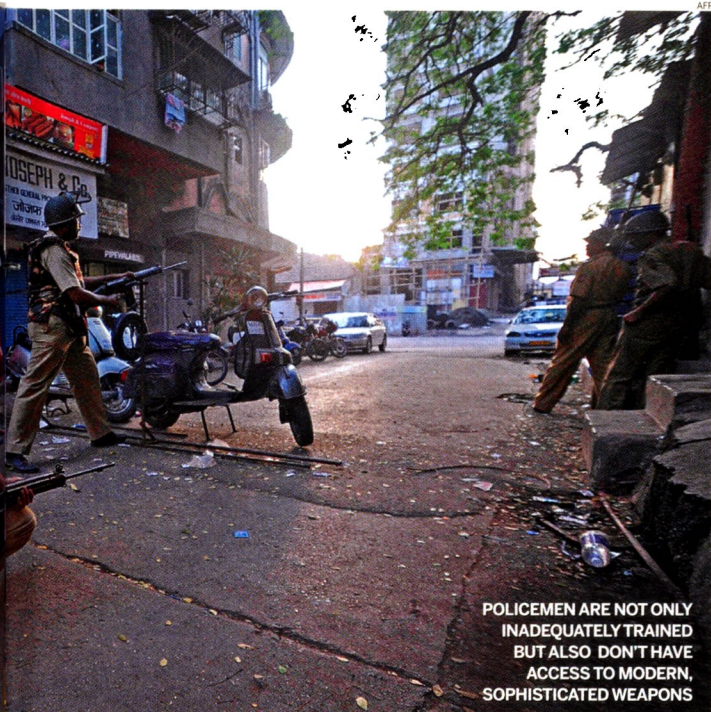




POLICEMEN ARE NOT ONLY INADEQUATELY TRAINED BUT ALSO DON'T HAVE ACCESS TO MODERN, SOPHISTICATED WEAPONS

nature that to meet them effectively, the country needs a highly motivated, professionally skilled, infrastructurally self-sufficient and sophisticatedly-trained police force," the Padmanabhaiah Committee noted presciently in 2000. Two years ago, the Second Administrative Commission headed by Moily listed inadequate training and infrastructure for the police was one of a dozen weaknesses in the legal framework.

To see the difference training and infrastructure can make to the police force, one has to visit the Counter Terrorism and Jungle Warfare School at Kanker in Chhattisgarh where state policemen undergo a six-month course. Besides equipping them to use modern weapons, the training physically conditions them, sharpens their reflexes and trains them to take the ini-

tiative in ambushes. The results are there to see. A kill ratio of five policemen for every Naxalite has been reversed to one policeman for five Naxalites in three years. The Home Ministry's plan to set up 20 such schools all over the country is a vindication of the need for such a reorientation.

An ideal place to begin changing the force would be in police control rooms, perhaps the most overlooked aspect of metro policing. In military strategy and business parlance, the Observe-Orient-Decide-Act or the OODA loop is said to be the most critical aspect of a fast unfolding situation. Police control rooms need to be immediately upgraded into large military-like command and communication hubs equipped with secure communication, phones, faxes and the Internet. They should

## Constabulary is the Key

A constable is the first line of defence and often the weakest link in the chain

**Education** A constable is required to have just a school-leaving certificate.

**Salary** Paid between Rs 3,200 to Rs 4,900, about that of a semi-skilled worker.

**Promotion** He can expect only one promotion in his lifetime and generally retires as a head constable.

**No application of mind** All investigative powers are with the SHO, leaving the constable as an automaton carrying out orders with no personal initiative.

### ALL INDIA VACANCIES

| Constables | Sub Inspectors | Dy SPs |
|------------|----------------|--------|
| 1.13 Lakh  | 18,654         | 2099   |

Courtesy: Ministry of Home Affairs

### URGENTLY NEEDED



1 lakh Level III bullet-proof jacket  
Rs 300 crore



1 lakh Kevlar helmets  
Rs 100 crore



1 lakh automatic carbines to replace .303 / SLR rifles  
Rs 5,000 crore

### Police-to-Population Ratio in Select Countries

| Country   | Police per lakh Population |
|-----------|----------------------------|
| India     | 142                        |
| Japan     | 175                        |
| UK        | 200                        |
| Germany   | 300                        |
| Australia | 290                        |
| USA       | 315                        |

Courtesy: Ministry of Home Affairs

